```
nonstatic();
nonstatic();
nonstatic();
nonstatic();

echo nonstatic(), "\n";

?>
```

In the above example, we have a normal, non-static variable. We increment the variable each time the function is called. We call the function 5 times. However, non-static variables are initiated for each call of the function. After 5 function calls the $value equals to 2.

The static variables are initiated only once, when the function is first called. They retain their value afterwards.

static.php

```
<?php

function staticfun() {

    static $value = 0;
    $value += 1;

    return $value;
}

staticfun();
staticfun();
staticfun();
staticfun();

echo staticfun(), "\n";
```

Remember

Function name must be start with letter and underscore only like other labels in PHP. It can't be start with numbers or special symbols.